University of St Andrews

Mathematics and Statistics

Regius Professor of Mathematics



University of St Andrews

Introduction



"Our remarkable students and staff are the lifeblood of St Andrews. It is their energy, vision and momentum [we] aim to support, to free them to use knowledge, ideas, and potential for the benefit of all." The Principal, Professor Sally Mapstone

Founded in 1413, the University of St Andrews is Scotland's first university and one of the oldest in the English-speaking world. With more than 600 years of academic excellence, we are proud of our reputation as a world-class centre for learning, teaching, and research.

St Andrews is a close-knit, international community set in a beautiful historic town on Scotland's east coast. Our students and staff come from over 140 countries, creating a diverse and globally minded environment. We strive to create an inclusive culture in which all can flourish, and the University have attained several diversity awards, including those related to race and gender equality, and support for carers, which demonstrate our commitment to this ambition. The University is consistently ranked among the UK's top institutions for student satisfaction, research quality, and teaching excellence.

We are a research-intensive university where creativity, collaboration, and critical inquiry are at the heart of everything we do. Whether you are joining us in an academic, professional, or support role, you will be part of a team committed to delivering outstanding education and making a meaningful contribution to society.

For those looking to be part of a university with deep-rooted heritage, a global outlook, and a forward-thinking approach, we invite you to consider joining our community at the University of St Andrews.

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Mathematics and Statistics

The School of Mathematics and Statistics is dedicated to pursuing world class research in its areas of expertise, delivering top class education to its students, and maintaining a friendly professional environment conducive to these goals. We have 53 permanent members of academic staff and 11 permanent support staff. We also currently have 30 research staff and 55 PhD students, including some jointly supervised in the School of Mathematics & Statistics and other Schools, including Biology, Computer Science and Medicine.

The School comprises three divisions: Pure Mathematics, Applied Mathematics, and Statistics, reflecting our broad coverage of the subject and the portfolio of courses and degrees we offer. Our current research activity is broadly reflected in our research groups: Algebra and Combinatorics, Analysis, Geometry, Mathematical Biology, Solar and Magnetospheric Theory, Vortex Dynamics, Ecological and Environmental Statistics, Statistical Methodology, Statistical Medicine and Molecular Biology, and History of Mathematics. The School's large and diverse PhD programme is supported through funding from a variety of sources, including research councils and charitable trusts.

Overall, 98% of research carried out by the School of Mathematics and Statistics at the University of St Andrews is world-leading or internationally excellent, according to the results of the Research Excellence Framework (REF 2021). This reflects the School's long-term strategy of recruitment of high-quality academic staff, increasing external research funding and creating new research groups, and a continued commitment to translating our academic research into impact through growing interdisciplinary collaborations and international partnerships. The School has an outstanding record in attracting external research funding.



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The main funders are the research councils, especially EPSRC and STFC. We also receive funding from the EU, NERC, the Leverhulme Trust, the Nuffield Foundation, the Royal Society, the LMS, and others. Engagement with organisations outside academia is a major contributor to the strength of our impact case studies for REF, which scored a GPA of 3.75/4 in REF2021.

At the undergraduate level, the School offers BSc and MMath degree courses in Mathematics and Statistics with a range of specialisations, and also a great variety of joint degrees offered in collaboration with other Schools. We recruit substantial numbers of Scottish, rest of UK, EU and overseas students, all of whom come with the highest qualifications. We teach in moderate to small classes, especially in higher-level modules. We pride ourselves on the quality of our teaching: our undergraduate programmes are highly rated in all the national league tables, routinely coming within the top five in the UK and top in Scotland. Most of our advanced modules reflect our research expertise and interests. Our undergraduates are highly employable in a variety of professions, including a significant proportion each year who enroll for PhD studies at St Andrews or elsewhere.

At Masters level the Pure and Applied Divisions offer an MSc Mathematics and an MSc Mathematical Biology. The Division of Statistics offers MSc programmes in Statistics, Statistical Ecology, Applied Statistics & Datamining and Data Intensive Analysis, the latter run jointly with the School of Computer Science.



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Mathematics and Statistics

The main School building, the Mathematical Institute, houses staff offices, administration offices, lecture theatres, tutorial rooms, a computer classroom and a staff room. The Mathematics Library is housed in the adjacent Physics Building. Some statisticians in the School are located in a nearby dedicated building housing the Centre for Research into Ecological and Environmental Modelling.

Further information about the School of Mathematics and Statistics at St Andrews can be found at on the School website.

The School of Mathematics and Statistics is committed to creating an inclusive and welcoming environment that supports equality of opportunity and fair and equal representation for all Equality, diversity and inclusion.



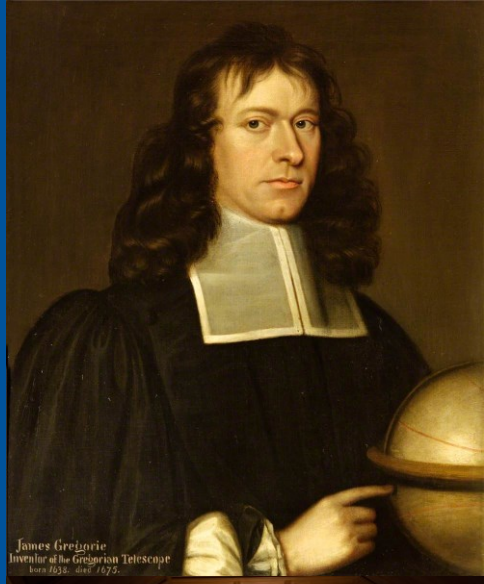
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The Regius Chair

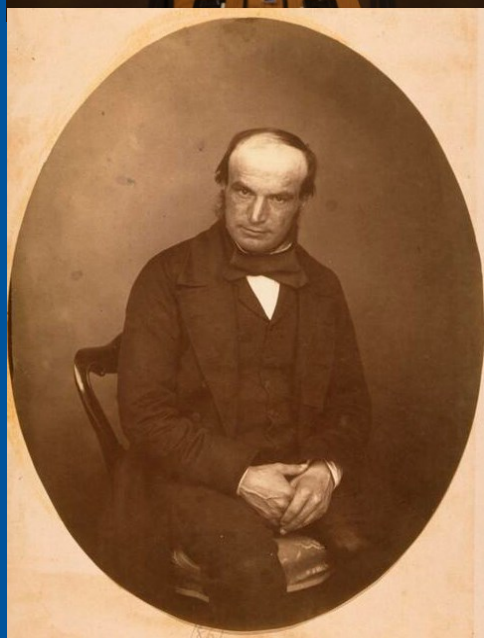
The Regius Chair of Mathematics at the University of St Andrews was established by King Charles II in 1668. This prestigious position, the oldest of four Regius Chairs of Mathematics in the UK, was first held by James Gregory and has since been held by mathematicians, including John Couch Adams, who have contributed to developments across pure and applied mathematics, with work in areas such as analysis, algebra, geometry, and mathematical physics.

Today the Regius Professor is a senior academic leader within the School of Mathematics and Statistics, contributing to its strategic direction and to its ambitions in world-leading research and education. The new Chair will have an outstanding track record of research and academic achievement in any area of the mathematical sciences. We anticipate the appointment expanding our existing research portfolio in a significant way, potentially including the formation of a new research group, while synergies with our current expertise are also welcome.

The appointment offers a rare opportunity to build on a distinguished legacy and shape how mathematics develops here in the years ahead.







Upper image: Portrait of James Gregory, attributed to John Scougal
Middle image: Martyrs Kirk Research Library, © University of St Andrews, CC BY-NC Creative Commons Attribution-Non Commercial 4.0 International Public License
Lower image: Photograph of Professor [John Couch] Adams, courtesy of University of St Andrews Libraries and Museums

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Job Description

Reporting to:	The Head of School
Location:	St Andrews
Job Family:	Academic (Education and Research)
Working Hours:	36.25 hours per week
Grade/Salary Range:	Grade 9 /by negotiation
Reference Number:	AC2380LS
Start Date:	4 January 2027 or thereafter by negotiation
Interview Date:	10 November 2026
Duration of post:	Standard

Main Purpose of the Role

To strengthen the School of Mathematics and Statistics' record of excellence in the production of original research and the provision of outstanding teaching by

- Conducting, publishing and otherwise disseminating outstanding research that is world leading and meets the highest standards of excellence in terms of originality, significance and rigour
- Enhancing the School's research culture by attracting significant external research funding and graduate students
- Teaching classes and delivering lectures to undergraduate and graduate students as well as supervising final year and Masters dissertations and doctoral theses
- Significantly contributing to the administration and senior management of the School's activities
- Demonstrate academic and intellectual leadership within the School and in the discipline more broadly

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Key Responsibilities

1. Engage in, publish and disseminate original internationally leading research in the mathematical sciences
2. Apply for and win significant external research funding
3. Provide effective leadership in the development and delivery of major research projects and programmes including, where appropriate, the development of interdisciplinary collaborations
4. Lead high-profile initiatives that enhance the School's national and international reputation and visibility, and support the wider impact of its research
5. Act as an ambassador for the School and University, promoting their strengths across the UK and internationally, and representing St Andrews within the mathematical sciences community
6. Promote excellence in teaching and learning, making a distinguished personal contribution to teaching at all levels
7. Teach and examine on courses at undergraduate and postgraduate level, including in areas related to your own research interests
8. Supervise and examine final year and Masters projects and doctoral theses in your specialist area
9. Attract and recruit graduate students, contributing to their development
10. Lead in the effective administration of specific areas of activity within the School/University (e.g. School Director of Research, Head of School) to help shape the School's future strategy in conjunction with other senior staff
11. Participate in committees and working groups within the School, the Faculty and the University as may be required
12. Mentor, support and advise junior staff and assist in their academic career development
13. Undertake major roles in the organisation of international conferences, workshops and summer schools for research
14. Contribute to and, where appropriate, lead peer review bodies, committees, professional organisations, learned societies, government committees or Research Councils
15. Undertake editorship of peer reviewed journals or monograph series and membership of editorial boards

Please note that this job description is not exhaustive, and the role holder may be required to undertake other relevant duties commensurate with the grading of the post. Activities may be subject to amendment over time as the role develops and/or priorities and requirements evolve.

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Person Specification

Attributes	Essential	Desirable	Means of Assessment (i.e. application form, interview, test, presentation etc.)
Education & Qualifications (*technical, professional, academic qualifications and training required)*	Hold a PhD in an area of mathematical sciences		Application/ Certificates
Experience & Knowledge (*examples of specific experience and knowledge sought*)	Outstanding research record Exemplary track record of high-quality research publications Outstanding track record of attracting and delivering on external research funding	Evidence of high-level participation in relevant academic and professional associations/bodies Award of professional prizes including fellowships Strong track record in attracting and supervising postgraduate students	Application/Interview /Presentation

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Person Specification

Attributes	Essential	Desirable	Means of Assessment (i.e. application form, interview, test, presentation etc.)
Experience & Knowledge (*examples of specific experience and knowledge sought*)	Experienced academic leader including editing, reviewing and refereeing, examining, invitations to conferences, keynote addresses etc. Experience of delivering high quality, inspirational and motivational teaching at undergraduate and postgraduate levels		Application/Interview /Presentation

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Person Specification

Attributes	Essential	Desirable	Means of Assessment (i.e. application form, interview, test, presentation etc.)
Competencies & Skills (*e.g. effective communication skills, initiative, flexibility, leadership etc*)	Ability to enthuse all students of mathematics Effective communicator Collegiality/ willingness to work in a collaborative environment	Ability and aptitude to engage in senior academic leadership, management, and planning Ability and aptitude to represent St Andrews in the UK and international mathematical sciences communities	Application/Interview /Presentation

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Benefits

St Andrews offers more than just a place to work—it is a place to belong. We value collegiality, inclusion, and wellbeing, and we are committed to creating a workplace where staff can thrive and perform at their best.

In addition to the salary on offer for this position, there are a wide range of benefits for staff working at the University of St Andrews. The package for the Regius Professor of Mathematics includes:

- Financial contribution to relocation (subject to eligibility)
- Membership of the USS Pension Scheme with a generous employer contribution of 14.5%
- A range of family friendly policies supporting work-life balance
- Staff discount scheme for local and national goods and services
- Free staff parking, employee Carshare and Cycle to Work Schemes and subsidised local bus travel
- Subsidised sports membership, reduced tuition fees on degree programmes for staff, access to training and development opportunities including LinkedIn Learning, access to library facilities, salary sacrifice scheme
- 34 Days Annual Leave plus 5 Public Holidays.



University of St Andrews

How to Apply



We are committed to creating an accessible, fair and inclusive recruitment process for all candidates. If you require reasonable adjustments or accommodations during the application or interview process then please let us know and we will be happy to discuss support with you.

We encourage applicants to apply online at www.vacancies.st-andrews.ac.uk/welcome.aspx

If you have difficulties in completing the online application form, then please call +44 (0)1334 461990 or contact vacancies@st-andrews.ac.uk to discuss available support.

Applications should consist of
- Letter of application
- CV and publications list
- Names and contacts of three referees

For all applications, please quote ref: AC2380LS

The University of St Andrews is a charity registered in Scotland (No SC013532).

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Equality, Diversity & Inclusion

At St Andrews, we see diversity as a strength and value the rich variety of backgrounds, identities and experiences of our staff, students and alumni. We are committed to making the University a beacon of inclusivity and creating an environment in where everyone can flourish and realise their potential.

We will achieve this through an approach that empowers our whole community and involves a determined shift in culture. Inclusivity will inform all of our policies and practices. The Principal, Professor Sally Mapstone

Diverse is a core theme of the University Strategy, and alongside our People Strategy, outlines a number of actions we are taking to create an inclusive culture. Our objectives include raising awareness of diversity events, initiatives and support, strengthening support for staff networks, creating more opportunities for employees to engage in consultations and discussions, offering a diverse range of rewarding career pathways and ensuring a working environment which supports positive working practices and behaviours.

We commit to providing a high-quality staff experience which enables all our staff to contribute, thrive, and perform at their best. By joining us at the University of St Andrews, you are joining a community which values difference, being your authentic self, and where you can play an active role in ensuring an inclusive environment for all.



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St Andrews

A modern location surrounded with ancient history, St Andrews is a dynamic and friendly town found on the east coast of Scotland. Situated in the Kingdom of Fife, St Andrews has easy links to nearby commuter towns and transport links (including airports) to the nearby cities of Dundee (13 miles) and Edinburgh (c. 1 hour by train).

Beyond the lecture halls and labs, St Andrews is home to stunning, unspoilt beaches and fresh sea air. Take a peaceful stroll or an energising walk with friends along the iconic two-mile stretch of the West Sands. If you prefer the water, ride the waves at the East Sands or try sailing, sea kayaking and windsurfing. For breathtaking views, a walk to the end of the stone pier is an experience not to be missed.

St Andrews and the surrounding area is home to a wide range of restaurants and shops, while boasting an array of beautiful beaches. St Andrews is also the home of golf and there are seven local courses including the famous Old Course.

Fife is an area filled history and culture. There are nearly 5,000 listed buildings and 50 conservation areas across the Kingdom, with some historic structures dating all the way back to the 12th century. St Andrews enjoys a microclimate and is typically much drier than western parts of the country.



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Further Information

The University encourages all interested candidates to apply, and all applications received are assessed against the essential and desirable criteria listed in the further particulars. The successful candidate will have to demonstrate their right to work in the UK prior to commencing employment and where required, obtain the right to work in the UK, the University can support with visa sponsorship.

You are expected to uphold a duty of care towards colleagues, students, and communities, and to actively contribute to a safe, respectful, and inclusive environment. This includes responding appropriately to disclosures or reports of sexual misconduct, gender-based violence, bullying, harassment, or other concerns, in line with organisational policies, and signposting individuals to the appropriate departments




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